

# "WE ARE NOT A BRANCH OFFICE OF THE CONGRESS."



RAGHU RAI

## N.T. Rama Rao

So said Nandamuri Taraka Rama Rao when he became the second South Indian film star to be made chief minister, sweeping the Andhra Pradesh polls, winning 202 out of 294 seats. Rao, who often played Hindu deities in Telugu films, founded the Telugu Desam Party in 1982 "to protect the honour and self-respect" of 60 million Telugu-speaking people—the spark was Rajiv Gandhi's insult of Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister T. Anjaiah, when he went to Hyderabad airport to welcome him. NTR effortlessly rode his screen popularity to power in 1983, making Andhra Pradesh one of the few states in India at the time not swamped by the Congress wave.

● Island-wide anti-Tamil riots broke out in Sri Lanka in retaliation to the deaths of soldiers the day before and over 400 people died. This marked the beginning of the civil war in Sri Lanka.

● Cosmos 1402, a Russian nuclear powered satellite launched in 1982, fell into the Indian Ocean.

● An explosives-laden truck crashed into the US Marine barracks (below) near Beirut airport in Lebanon. The bomb killed 241 Marines and injured 80.

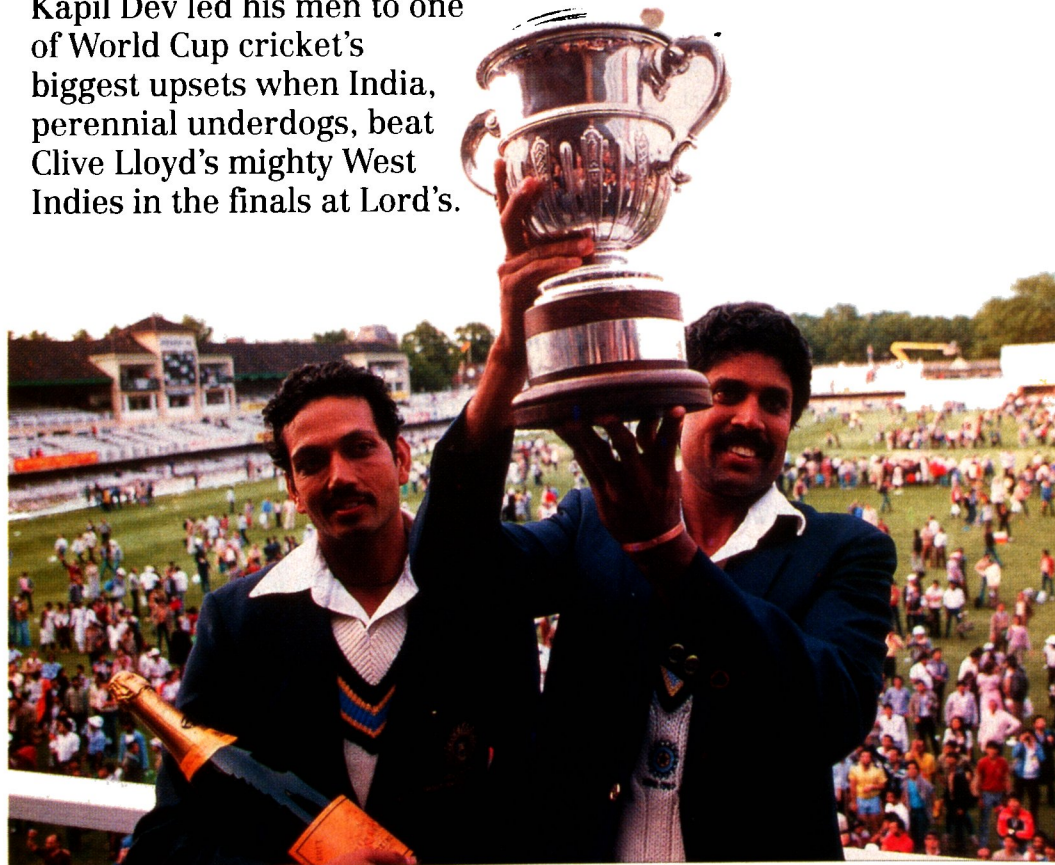
AP



## INDIA: 183; WEST INDIES: 140 ALL OUT

PATRICK EAGER

Kapil Dev led his men to one of World Cup cricket's biggest upsets when India, perennial underdogs, beat Clive Lloyd's mighty West Indies in the finals at Lord's.



## 31.5

lakh was the number of people in line for a telephone connection in India. Even the poor services—in Kolkata, every seventh phone was normally out of order—didn't deter people from applying for a connection.